

Tales from the Road

New marketing conquests and contact with innovative thinking of a different kind

Smooth talk

Ever so often, members of the Digit team travel to different parts of the country to hear directly from our readers about what they like in Digit and the kind of content they'd like to see more of. Recently, Nabeet Ganguli, Vinith Shetty and Hari Raghavan from the Digit Marketing team were on such a mission that took them to Aurangabad, Ahmednagar and Baroda, and brought them in touch with the student community in these cities.

Now, our marketing folk, like their ilk anywhere else, are glib-talking people, masters in the art of presentations. Their language of choice is Hinglish, but they smoothly shift to chaste English for hi-brow client meetings. Aurangabad was a different cup of tea however. Our elite marketing team were requested to communicate with the students in Hindi alone.

This was trouble as the trio's previ-

हमारे Subscribers almost 350 locations में spreadout हैं।



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

ous experience with chaste Hindi was limited to cursing and screaming obscenities and they found themselves for the first time spluttering, stammering and stuttering through their presentation.

But the disadvantage didn't last for long. They soon turned this into a friendly competition amongst themselves, trying to outdo each other in their Hindi speaking skills. To the extent that now that they are back in the office, they take wicked delight in throwing shudhh Hindi at the unsuspecting resident geeks.

On a different note, the threesome claim to have become experts in survival in any part of the country. They give advice to anyone who cares to listen, on how to tackle the local rickshawallas in different cities, and where to get food at odd hours.

In the meantime, we are thinking of revenge by sending them on a trip down south, where they can try their hands at Tamil too!

Toast of the town

Never the one to let go of an opportunity to visit his hometown Delhi, Deepak readily volunteered when the Test Centre needed to send some

reviewers up North. Badri, our latest recruit in the Test Centre, didn't, but was forced to tag along anyway. Unluckily for Badri, this trip was scheduled in the dead of winter and being a pukka Mumbai-ite he wasn't used to the chilly weather. So even while Badri acted as a cold tortoise, hiding inside the hood of his red jacket, Deepak, the Dilliwalla, insisted on taking him food hopping around the capital city.

First stop Dilli Haat. For those in the dark, Dilli Haat is famous for its various regional food

stalls from all across India. After a fulfilling meal of rajma-chawal from the Kashmir stall, Deepak decided to treat Badri to fruit beer (non-alcoholic we may add), a speciality. Since it's popular with the local crowd, most of the food stalls serve fruit beer. However, to their disappointment, they discovered that owing to a power outage, fruit beer was not available anywhere. But being Digit wallas, they were not prepared to take things at face value, and decided to investigate without much luck until they chanced upon the Bihar stall. This was the only stall dishing out fruit beer by the glassful. And no, they hadn't hit on a way to technologically bypass the electricity outage—the Bihar stall was using regular bottled soda for making the fruit beer (instead of the more common albeit unusable electric fountain machines). Three cheers to innovative thinking! 🍷

